# Work Breakdown Structure (WBS) Template · Expert version

A work breakdown structure template helps you decompose a project into deliverables and work packages, each with a WBS code, owner, effort and cost, so nothing is missed and estimates roll up correctly.

## How to use this template

1. Write the project's final deliverable as level 1.
2. Break it into major deliverables or phases at level 2, then into work packages at level 3.
3. Give each element a unique WBS code, a short description and a single owner.
4. Estimate effort and cost for each work package; the top row totals them.
5. Check the 100% rule: the children of each element add up to all of its work, and nothing more.
6. Use the work packages to build your schedule and budget.

## Tips

- Name elements with nouns (deliverables), not verbs.
- Stop decomposing when a work package can be estimated and assigned.
- Keep a WBS dictionary for detail.
- Do not include work that is out of scope.

## Dashboard (sample data)

| Field | Value | Count |
|---|---|---|
| Owner | Business analyst | 1 |
| Owner | Design lead | 1 |
| Owner | Ops lead | 1 |
| Owner | Project manager | 2 |
| Owner | QA lead | 1 |
| Owner | Tech lead | 1 |
| Owner | Trainer | 1 |
| Status | Not started | 4 |
| Status | In progress | 3 |
| Status | On hold | 0 |
| Status | Blocked | 0 |
| Status | Done | 1 |

## WBS · Decompose deliverables into work packages; totals roll up automatically

| WBS code | Level | Deliverable / work package | Description | Owner | Effort (days) | Cost ($) | Status |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 1 | Customer portal | The complete project | Project manager | 96 | 76,800 | In progress |
| 1.1 | 2 | Project management | Planning, reporting, governance | Project manager | 10 | 8,000 | In progress |
| 1.2 | 2 | Requirements | Workshops and signed-off requirements | Business analyst | 8 | 6,400 | Done |
| 1.3 | 2 | Design | UX and technical design | Design lead | 12 | 9,600 | In progress |
| 1.4 | 2 | Build | Front end, back end and integrations | Tech lead | 40 | 32,000 | Not started |
| 1.5 | 2 | Testing | System and user acceptance testing | QA lead | 15 | 12,000 | Not started |
| 1.6 | 2 | Training | Guides and sessions for support staff | Trainer | 5 | 4,000 | Not started |
| 1.7 | 2 | Deployment | Release and hypercare | Ops lead | 6 | 4,800 | Not started |
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